

Study Buddy for Blackberry

IMS announced Study Buddy app for BlackBerry smartphones that helps students to prepare for their competitive exams

**Where's My Water?**

The Mystery Duck developed by Disney provides some interesting puzzles and challenges for iOS gamers

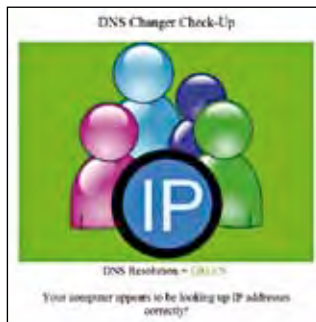
Internet Doomsday: Are you still online?

In the last stage of Operation Ghost Click, the FBI planned to pull the plug and bring down the temporary rogue DNS servers on July 9. As a result, PCs still infected by the DNSChanger virus would be unable to access the Internet. The original doomsday was to fall on March

through infected PCs to fake or unsafe websites, most of them running online scams. There are also reports that the DNSChanger virus also acts as a trojan, allowing perpetrators of the hack attack to gain access to infected PCs.

The group behind the DNSChanger virus is estimated to have infected close to 4 million PCs around the world in 2011, until the FBI shut them down in November. Google issued a general advisory for netizens in May earlier this year to detect and remove DNSChanger from infected PCs. According to the reports by DNS Changer Working Group (DCWG), nearly 300,000 systems were still infected with the virus, with a maximum of over 69,500 such system in the US. Italy with about 26,500 infected systems is at the second place, followed by India (21,300).

Security firms reported no significant outages linked to the DNSChanger virus, as many internet service providers have either implemented a fix or contacted customers with steps to clean their computers. **[i]**



8, but thankfully FBI found a way to delay the date to give users more time to ensure their computer's security.

After gaining access to a host PC, the DNSChanger virus tries to modify the DNS (Domain Name Server) settings, which are essential for Internet access, to send traffic to malicious servers. These poisoned web addresses in turn point traffic generated

Data loss due to glitch at Yahoo!

A system failure in a rental server service operated by a Yahoo! Japan Corp. subsidiary devoured the data of 5,698 firms, including information for their websites. The Osaka based Firstserver Inc.

failed to retrieve the data; it has also lost the backup data. The glitch occurred when the company tried to upgrade its system's security. The system failure was attributed to problems with computer programming and operational procedures. **[i]**

SIM Card Cloning

BSNL and other telecom operators are issuing alerts to their subscribers to beware of suspicious calls. If you get a missed call from a number that starts with +92, #90 or #09, don't show the courtesy to call back. You might be the next victim of SIM card cloning. More than one lakh people have already fallen prey to this 'telecom terror attack'. It will be a smart move to not share your personal information such as bank account details with anyone, moreover not store it on your phone. If

your phone has been cloned, information can be extracted from its memory, and calls be made from your SIM.

Cloning a SIM using a hardware tool that can extract the authentication key from it and copy it to another, is a well known process. But retrieving information from the SIM remotely, is a job for the highly trained and requires very expensive tools. It may even require hacking into the telecom operator's network. Is this the level of safety in our society now? **[i]**

Eyes of the sky: Drones hijacked

Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV), aka drone is an aircraft without a human pilot onboard. It is operated either remotely or autonomously by a computer on the vehicle. US has been actively using drones in its military reconnaissance.

But are the drones fully under the control of authorities? A civilian drone was hijacked in Texas for a USD 1,000 wager. Prof. Todd Humphreys and his grad students at the University of Texas, Austin hacked into the drone's GPS signals before the weary eyes of the DHS (Department of Homeland Security) officials, who bet on the aircraft's security.

The experiment was conducted in the University of Texas stadium, using a technique called 'spoofing', where a signal is sent to the on-board GPS by the hackers, which imi-

tates the one sent by the Ground Control System. The small but powerful red drone soared into the sky, and shortly after, the aircraft veered to the side, making it obvious that it was no longer following its original orders. Then, the drone hurtled toward the ground as if given a self-destruct command and was saved in the last moment.

In October 2011, a virus that keeps a log of what people type was found in computers that pilot the US drones at Creech Air Force Base in Nevada. No harm was done, yet it was running on classified computers.

All this seemingly raised concern about the vulnerabilities of drone, being used both for the military and domestic purposes. Its usage will soon be extended to local police departments, energy companies and farmers looking to feed thirsty crops. **[i]**